

SDG Goal 16

Peace, justice and strong institutions

SDG Target 16.3

Promote the rule of law at the national and international levels and ensure equal access to justice for all

SDG Indicator 16.3.1

Proportion of victims of (a) physical, (b) psychological and/or (c) sexual violence in the previous 12 months who reported their victimization to competent authorities or other officially recognized conflict resolution mechanisms

Time series

Reporting rate of physical, psychological and sexual violence

1. General information on the time series

- Date of national metadata: February 12, 2026
- National data: <https://sdg-indicators.de/16-3-1>
- Definition: The time series show the reporting rates of physical, psychological and sexual violence in the previous 12 months.

(a) Physical violence

The offence category 'physical violence' comprises the following individual offences:

- Assault
- Robbery

Since the 2020 reporting year, the single offence category of 'assault' has included the following individual offences:

- Assault by several persons with a weapon
- Assault by one person with a weapon
- Assault by several persons without a weapon
- Assault by one person without a weapon

(c) Sexual violence (since 2020)

The offence category 'sexual violence' includes the following individual offences:

- Physical sexual harassment
- Disaggregation: type of violence, age group, sex, type of physical violence, type of sexual violence

2. Comparability with the UN metadata

- Date of UN metadata: July 2016
- UN metadata: <https://unstats.un.org/sdgs/metadata/files/Metadata-16-03-01.pdf>
- The time series is compliant with the UN metadata. It comprises exclusively results from victimisation surveys (so-called dark field surveys) and is not based on cases recorded by the police (so-called light field statistics).

3. Data description

- The reporting rate is calculated as the ratio between the number of incidents experienced by victims and the number of cases that are reported.

Reporting years 2012 and 2017:

The data comes from the German Victimisation Surveys (DVS), which were conducted in the form of computer-assisted telephone interviews (CATI) in 2012 (n=35,503) and 2017 (n=31,192) on behalf of the Federal Criminal Police Office (BKA). In order to be able to identify changes between the 2012 and 2017 surveys, the 2017 survey was conducted in much the same way as the 2012 survey. The survey is based on a random sample of the population living in private households who are aged 16 or older and can be reached by telephone. Since people with a relatively high level of education are overrepresented in the sample and young adults (aged 18 to 34) are underrepresented compared to the overall population, the responses were weighted to take into account the unequal probability of participation in the survey for these groups of people. For this time series, the response to the question of whether a person had been the victim of a physical assault at least once in the last 12 months was used.

Reporting year 2020:

The data comes from the study 'Security and Crime in Germany' (SKiD), which was conducted for the first time in 2020 (n=45,351) in cooperation between the Federal Criminal Police Office (BKA) and the state police forces. The results are representative of the population aged 16 and over living in private households in Germany. The data collection was designed as a simultaneous mixed-mode design, in which the selected individuals could choose to participate in the survey either in writing by post (paper-and-pencil interview, PAPI) or online (computer-assisted web interview, CAWI). In terms of content, the survey covered three main topics in particular: 1) victim experiences and reporting behaviour, 2) sense of security and fear of crime, and 3) experiences with and opinions about the police.

The results of studies on the extent of crime and victimisation are not comparable with the figures from the Police Crime Statistics (PCS) for the following reasons:

- Reference period
- Population
- Offence categorisation
- Identification of multiple victims
- Equivalence of offences

4. Access to data source

- Not available

5. Metadata on source data

- Dark field research / Victimization Surveys (only available in German):
https://www.bka.de/DE/AktuelleInformationen/StatistikenLagebilder/ViktimisierungsurveyDunkelfeldforschung/viktimisierungssurveyDunkelfeldforschung_node.html

- Methodology report on the 2012 German Victimization Survey (only available in German):
<https://www.bka.de/SharedDocs/Downloads/DE/Publikationen/Publikationsreihen/Forschungsergebnisse/2013MethodenberichtZumDeutschenViktimisierungssurvey2012.html?nn=27638>
- Methodology report on the 2017 German Victimization Survey (only available in German):
<https://www.bka.de/SharedDocs/Downloads/DE/Publikationen/Publikationsreihen/Forschungsergebnisse/2018methodenberichtDVS2017.html?nn=27638>

6. Timeliness and frequency

- Timeliness: t + 24 months
- Frequency: Irregular

7. Calculation method

- Unit of measurement: Percentage
- Calculation: Not applicable.